



March 14, 2025

AI Action Plan
Attn: Faisal D'Souza
National Coordination Office
2415 Eisenhower Avenue
Alexandria, VA 22314

Re: UltraPass Response to White House AI Action Plan

OVERVIEW:

Beyond hardware and chips, data is the single most critical input to AI development. Data is the preeminent strategic asset in the AI era. As AI and large language models (LLMs) become a foundational technology for economic and national security, digital identity will be a key determinant of AI dominance. Those with access to the most valuable data will determine AI superiority, and digital identity technologies are emerging as a central infrastructure for global data flows. Digital identity technologies are the gateway to citizens' most sensitive data, and who controls them will shape the future of AI, governance, and global power. These systems will sit at the core of trillions of transactions, influencing economies, societies, and even individual thought. With billions already in use, digital identity solutions are being deployed globally at an accelerating pace, with applications spanning every industry - from healthcare and education to energy and global trade - securing high-value data exchanges. These systems are rapidly becoming prime targets for adversary nations, seeking to infiltrate and amass unprecedented volumes of data at an unimaginable scale.

Companies - and countries - that embed themselves in the digital identity infrastructure will have the ability to siphon vast amounts of sensitive data, fueling AI models that could shape the world in ways counter to U.S. interests. If the U.S. wants to maintain leadership in emerging technologies and AI, we cannot afford to let that happen. Ensuring the integrity of digital identity systems is not just a matter of cybersecurity - it is a national security imperative that will dictate who drives the international world order.

China recognizes this reality and is rapidly embedding itself into digital identity infrastructure worldwide, leveraging its Digital Silk Road to gain privileged access to vast troves of transactional, biometric, and behavioral data. If adversarial actors dominate digital identity systems, they won't just own today's data—they

will train tomorrow's AI models, embedding authoritarian values into global world order. The U.S. cannot afford another 5G / Huawei moment. Just as control over 5G networks and associated tech stacks dictated access to global communications, control over digital identity will determine who shapes next-generation AI governance systems.

Without a concerted effort to support U.S. digital identity solutions and interests abroad, the U.S. risks ceding global influence to China's AI-driven governance model, allowing Beijing to shape how identity, data, and digital ecosystems function across key regions like Southeast Asia, Africa, and Latin America. Without U.S. alternatives, China will set the global standards for identity verification, digital trust, and AI-powered governance, undermining U.S. leadership and compromising the integrity of critical systems. The U.S. must act decisively to safeguard digital identity infrastructure, secure AI training data, and prevent adversarial control over the digital economy. This must be a core pillar of the U.S. AI Action Plan, ensuring that democratic values, privacy protections, and American technological leadership define the future of AI—not authoritarian surveillance models.

It is critical to counter China's influence in digital identity infrastructure and promote a U.S.-led digital identity ecosystem that ensures economic security, national security, and global digital trust. The U.S. cannot lose its eye on the competition unfolding in the region and counter China's dominance in digital ID infrastructure, biometric databases, and identity verification technologies. The U.S. - along with like-minded nations in the Indo-Pacific - need to prevent reliance on Chinese / Chinese-influenced firms for digital ID infrastructure, hardware, and AI-driven verification to blunt Chinese efforts to control global ID systems, particularly in developing nations.

RECOMMENDATIONS:

To secure digital identity as a foundation for AI leadership, I recommend the following actions for consideration to strengthen national security, counter Chinese influence, and expand U.S. digital identity innovation to lead the global market to ensure secure digital ecosystems, and enable U.S. leadership in AI.

- White House / National Security Council:
 - Include digital ID resilience as a key area of collaboration with allies and partners in the Indo-Pacific in the national strategies.
 - Position the U.S. as the dominant provider of secure, privacy-preserving digital ID solutions.

- Intelligence Community:
 - Conduct annual assessments on China's influence in global digital ID markets and implications for U.S. national security, as well as potential Chinese cyber threats targeting digital ID databases.
 - Establish information sharing mechanisms with like-minded countries on vulnerabilities and concerns on the use of Chinese apps and platforms for Digital ID verification.
- Department of Commerce:
 - Incentivize U.S. firms to export digital ID technology to emerging markets.
 - Entity List Expansion: Restrict Chinese companies (e.g., Huawei, ZTE, CloudWalk, Megvii, Hikvision) from supplying AI, biometrics, or digital ID infrastructure to U.S. or allied nations.
 - Digital Identity Export Strategy: Support U.S. companies in scaling trusted Digital ID solutions globally.
- Department of State:
 - Digital Infrastructure Diplomacy: educate and expand awareness to like-minded nations in procuring and deploying U.S. alternatives to Chinese solutions.
 - Prioritize and support regional digital ID infrastructure in the Indo-Pacific to prevent adoption of China's Digital Silk Road solutions.
 - Establish financing for non-Chinese digital ID solutions in developing nations in the Indo-Pacific at risk of adopting Beijing's digital identity solutions.
- Congress / Legislative Actions
 - Congressional Funding for Secure Digital ID Innovation: \$500M+ in competitive grants for U.S. firms working on privacy-first Digital ID technologies.
 - Hearings on China Digital Silk Road and implications for AI leadership.

CONCLUSION: THE STRATEGIC IMPERATIVE



The future of AI leadership, economic security, and digital sovereignty will be shaped by who controls the foundational infrastructure of digital identity technologies. If the U.S. does not act decisively, it risks allowing China to dominate AI-driven identity verification, population-scale data collection, and the global digital economy. We cannot risk losing U.S. tech leadership in a critical 21st-century domain.

The recommendations above ensure digital ID development aligns with U.S. national security, economic leadership, and democratic values—while blocking China's ability to dominate this space. Promoting opportunities for U.S. companies and technologies overseas is key for global leadership and market share, enhancing the strength of the U.S. economy, as well as ensuring that the future of AI and technology, economic security, and national security align with the U.S. values.

The time to act is now. The U.S. must ensure that the technology underpinning digital identity—one of the most critical enablers of AI, the digital ecosystems, and international economies—is built on a foundation of security, trust, and American leadership - both at home and in one of the most consequential regions in the world - the Indo-Pacific.

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